

diarrheal deaths annually and save Rs 8.28 lakh crore ($101 billion) in healthcare costs. The mission has also saved 5.5 crore hours daily, with 75 per cent of the beneficiaries being women, significantly reducing physical strain.

Beyond health and convenience, JJM has driven substantial employment generation. During its construction phase, it has created 59.93 lakh person-years of direct jobs and 2.22 crore person-years of indirect jobs. Looking ahead, the operation and maintenance phase is expected to generate 11.18 lakh person-years of employment annually, ensuring long-term economic benefits alongside its social impact.

But securing India's water future isn't just about ensuring access—it is also about preserving and replenishing it. Water doesn't wait. It falls, flows, and disappears—unless we capture it. That's the philosophy behind the **Jal Shakti Abhiyan**, launched in 2019 as a 'an Andolan' (people's movement) for water conservation. Since then, millions have joined hands to build rainwater harvesting structures, check dams, recharge defunct wells, and revive ponds and tanks, breathing new life into parched landscapes.

In 2021, Prime Minister Modi launched the "Jal Shakti Abhiyan: Catch the Rain" (JSA: CTR) with the theme "Catch the Rain – Where it Falls When it Falls". In 2024, the theme of the JSA: CTR campaign was "*Nari Shakti se Jal Shakti*" (Water Power through Women Power). Through this campaign, the important role of women in water conservation was highlighted. With over 1.69 crore interventions—from reviving traditional water bodies to creating watershed projects—the campaign has reshaped the nation's water map.



> India, under the visionary leadership of the Prime Minister Modi, has placed water security at the core of India's development agenda. Through bold reforms, cutting-edge technology, and a renewed focus on conservation, we are reshaping the way water is managed across the country."
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> **C. R. Patil**
> **Union Minister of Jal Shakti**

Expanding this mission, **Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari,** launched in Surat in 2024, pushes for hyper-local solutions, urging citizens, industries, and traders to invest in groundwater recharge. The goal? A million artificial recharge structures. So far, 6.59 lakh have been initiated, with over 5.26 lakh completed.

This movement isn't just about storing water; it's about securing the future. From promoting climate-resilient farming through Sahi Fasal to championing sustainable soil practices, India is crafting a blueprint for long-term water security—one drop, one village, one community at a time.

India's rivers are at the heart of this conservation drive. The **Namami Gange Mission** is India's boldest river revival effort, tackling pollution and restoring the Ganga's lifeblood through a holistic, basin-wide approach. Recognized by the UN as one of the world's top restoration projects, it weaves together sewage treatment, ecological conservation, and community engagement to breathe life back into the sacred river.

With Rs 40,120 crore invested across 492 projects, the mission has built 6,255 MLD of sewage treatment capacity, laid 5,249 km of sewer networks, and restored 289 ghats and ponds. From clearing floating waste to modernizing cremation sites, every intervention is designed to keep the river clean and flowing.

Beyond infrastructure, the movement thrives on public participation—volunteers, known as Ganga Praharis, are its grassroots champions. Their efforts, combined with scientific interventions, have transformed the river's ecosystem. The resurgence of Gangetic dolphins, turtles, and the prized Hilsa fish signals a Ganga on the mend—not just a river, but a living, thriving entity reclaiming its place in India's heart.

A pivotal move in 2019 saw PM Modi merge the Ministry of Water Resources, River Development & Ganga Rejuvenation with the Department of Drinking Water & Sanitation and the National River Conservation Directorate from MoEFCC, accelerating water conservation efforts. Today, the **Swachh Bharat Mission** (Gramin) under the Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation is driving waste management, with 75 per cent of villages declaring themselves ODF Plus and 1,740 rural plastic waste units operational for recycling. Beyond sanitation, the impact is economic and social—households save an estimated Rs 50,000 annually in health costs, and 90 per cent of rural women feel safer with access to household toilets.

A comprehensive approach to water management requires knowing what we have and where. For the first time, India has mapped its water wealth—natural and man-made—through a nationwide Census of Water Bodies. Over 24 lakh ponds, lakes, and tanks have been catalogued, exposing stark contrasts between rural and urban water access and the extent of encroachment. This isn't just data; it's a blueprint for safeguarding the country's most vital resource.

Meanwhile, the **National Hydrology Project (NHP)** is transforming water monitoring with real-time intelligence. A network of 24,000 groundwater and surface water stations now streams live data into a centralized system, offering a pulse check on India's water reserves. In a country where every drop counts, these efforts are setting the stage for smarter water management and resilience against future crises.

Atal Bhujal Yojana is rewriting India's groundwater story—not through extraction, but through conservation. Targeting water-stressed